

STATEMENT OF WORK

Alzheimer's Disease Biomarker Initiative

Requisition/Project No.: PCA-NIA-01589

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1. GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1 Title

Alzheimer's Disease Biomarker Initiative

1.2 Statement of Need

The National Institutes of Health (NIH), Intramural Center for Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias, requires proteomic biomarker testing services using the CNS panel 220 Argo NULISA platform for Government-provided biospecimens. The purpose of this requirement is to identify biomarkers associated with underlying molecular changes in Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias (AD/ADRD) using well-characterized patient samples.

1.3 Background

The NIH Intramural Center for Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias is an interdisciplinary initiative dedicated to advancing the understanding, diagnosis, and treatment of Alzheimer's disease and related dementias. Biomarkers are critical for understanding disease mechanisms, supporting diagnosis, and monitoring disease progression and therapeutic efficacy. NIH requires high-throughput, quality-controlled proteomic analysis to support these objectives.

1.4 Objective

The objective of this requirement is to obtain high-quality proteomic biomarker data from Government-furnished biospecimens through standardized NULISA testing, including appropriate normalization, bridging controls, quality control procedures, and reporting sufficient to support cross-cohort harmonization and downstream scientific analysis.

2. SCOPE OF WORK

2.1 General

The Contractor shall, except as otherwise specified herein, furnish all management, supervision, labor, facilities, materials, equipment, supplies, transportation, and other resources necessary to perform the services required under this Statement of Work (SOW). The Contractor shall perform all work in accordance with the terms and conditions of the contract, applicable federal laws and regulations, and prevailing professional and scientific standards.

The Contractor shall perform CNS panel 220 Argo NULISA proteomic analysis on Government-furnished biospecimens and shall generate quality control, and deliver the required data and reports in accordance with this SOW.

2.2 Required Services

2.2.1 Sample Processing Volumes

The Contractor shall process up to the following maximum number of biospecimens during each contract period:

Base Year: August 1, 2026 through July 31, 2027

Maximum total: **8,970 samples**

- PREVENT-AD cohort: **3,738**
- Geneva cohort: **2,131**
- DABNI/SPUN cohort: **3,101**

Option Year 1: August 1, 2027 through July 31, 2028

Maximum total: **8,970 samples**

- DABNI/SPUN cohort: **1,406**
- K-ROAD cohort: **7,564**

Option Year 2: August 1, 2028 through July 31, 2029

Maximum total: **8,970 samples**

- K-ROAD cohort: **1,236**
- Unspecified neurodegenerative disease cohort: **7,734**

The Government does not guarantee the minimum number of samples unless expressly stated elsewhere in the contract. Quantities identified herein are maximum estimated quantities for planning and pricing purposes unless otherwise stated in the award document.

2.2.2 Analytical Requirements

The Contractor shall:

1. Perform CNS panel 220 Argo NULISA proteomic analysis on all Government-furnished biospecimens submitted under this contract.
2. Run pooled Government samples with known analytes on each plate for normalization during quantification of proteins and library preparation, when such samples are furnished by the Government.
3. Include a NuLISA quality control bridging cohort to assess analytical performance over time and normalize datasets.
4. Ensure the QC bridging cohort is matched to the relevant biofluid of interest, including:
 - cerebrospinal fluid (CSF), or
 - EDTA plasma.

5. Use the QC bridging cohort across multiple Government sample cohorts to support dataset harmonization among cohorts.
6. Use the QC bridging cohort to control for:
 - o lot-to-lot variation,
 - o between-cohort variation, and
 - o batch effects requiring correction.
7. Include quality control measures consisting of:
 - o a NuLISA plate for external controls, and
 - o internal Contractor controls sufficient to monitor and control individual plate variance.
8. Maintain throughput capacity sufficient to prepare NuLISA libraries for up to 2,400 samples per week.
9. Provide raw sequencing data in FASTQ format via a secure cloud-based delivery method within two (2) weeks after receipt of prepared libraries, unless otherwise approved in writing by the Contracting Officer.
10. Perform quality control review of generated data and provide final QC-reviewed results to the Government within an additional two (2) weeks, provided all applicable QC benchmarks have been met.

2.3 Standards of Performance

The Contractor shall perform all services in a timely, competent, and professional manner consistent with:

- the current manufacturer's platform requirements;
- accepted industry standards for proteomic laboratory analysis;
- all applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations; and
- the terms and conditions of the contract.

2.4 Contractor Responsibility for Means and Methods

The Contractor shall be responsible for the professional quality, technical accuracy, completeness, and coordination of all services performed under this contract. The Contractor shall, without additional compensation, correct or revise any errors, omissions, deficiencies, or nonconforming services resulting from Contractor fault or failure to comply with contract requirements.

3. PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE

The period of performance shall be as follows:

- **Base Year:** August 1, 2026 through July 31, 2027
- **Option Year 1:** August 1, 2027 through July 31, 2028
- **Option Year 2:** August 1, 2028 through July 31, 2029

Exercise of option periods, if any, shall be at the sole discretion of the Government and subject to the terms of the contract.

4. CONTRACTOR REQUIREMENTS

4.1 General

The Contractor shall provide all qualified personnel, supervision, materials, equipment, systems, and facilities necessary to perform the required services, except those expressly identified as Government-furnished.

4.2 Personnel Qualifications

The Contractor shall assign personnel who are qualified by education, training, and experience to perform the required services. Contractor personnel shall be adequately trained in applicable laboratory procedures, quality control procedures, data handling, and security requirements.

4.3 Project Management

The Contractor shall designate a Project Manager who shall have authority to act for the Contractor on all matters relating to contract performance. The Project Manager shall be the primary point of contact for technical coordination, schedule management, issue resolution, and deliverable tracking.

4.4 Compliance

The Contractor shall comply with all applicable statutes, regulations, policies, and contract clauses, including but not limited to those relating to:

- confidentiality,
- privacy,
- data protection,
- biospecimen handling,
- shipping,
- workplace safety,
- records retention, and
- inspection and acceptance.

4.5 Subcontractors

The Contractor shall remain fully responsible for the performance of all subcontractors. No subcontract shall relieve the Contractor of its obligation to ensure full compliance with contract requirements. Subcontracting arrangements, if any, shall be in accordance with the terms of the contract and applicable law.

5. GOVERNMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

The Government shall:

1. Designate a Government point of contact, such as the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR), for technical coordination.
2. Furnish biospecimens and associated information necessary for performance, as available and as authorized for release.
3. Coordinate shipping and transfer of Government-furnished materials.
4. Provide pooled Government samples with known analytes for normalization, if applicable and available.
5. Review submitted deliverables and provide acceptance, rejection, or comments within a reasonable period.

6. Issue all contractual direction through the Contracting Officer. The COR may provide technical direction only to the extent authorized by the Contracting Officer and shall not alter the scope, price, terms, or conditions of the contract.

6. DELIVERABLES AND DELIVERY SCHEDULE

6.1 Required Deliverables

The Contractor shall furnish the following deliverables, as applicable to each cohort, batch, or reporting period:

1. Biomarker Readout File(s): CSV files containing log2 values for each biomarker.
2. Data Quality Control File(s): CSV files containing QC metrics and results.
3. QC Summary Report(s): PDF report(s) summarizing cohort-level and batch-level QC findings.
4. Raw Sequencing Data: FASTQ files delivered through a secure cloud server or other Government-approved secure method.
5. Bridging Sample Results: Separate CSV and PDF files documenting bridging cohort results and interpretation.
6. Study QC Results: Separate CSV and PDF files documenting study-level QC and harmonization-related findings.

6.2 Delivery Schedule

Unless otherwise approved in writing by the Contracting Officer:

- Raw sequencing data in FASTQ format shall be delivered within two (2) weeks after receipt of prepared libraries.
- Biomarker readouts, QC data files, and QC summary reports shall be delivered within two (2) weeks of sample processing.
- Final QC-reviewed results shall be delivered within an additional two (2) weeks, provided QC benchmarks are met.

6.3 Format and Transmission

All deliverables shall be submitted in the format specified in this SOW or as otherwise directed by the Government in writing. Electronic files shall be transmitted using secure, password-protected, and Government-approved methods.

6.4 Nonconforming Deliverables

Any deliverable that fails to conform to contract requirements may be rejected by the Government. Rejected deliverables shall be corrected and resubmitted by the Contractor at no additional cost to the Government within the timeframe specified by the Government.

7. REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

7.1 Routine Reporting

The Contractor shall provide biomarker readouts and quality control documentation in accordance with the delivery schedule. Reports shall be complete, accurate, and sufficiently detailed to permit Government review and scientific interpretation.

7.2 Content Requirements

At a minimum, reporting shall include:

- CSV files containing log2 biomarker values;
- CSV and PDF files describing bridging sample results;
- CSV and PDF files describing study QC results; and
- explanations of any QC failures, deviations, anomalies, or limitations affecting interpretation.

7.3 Communications

Routine communications may be conducted by email. The Contractor shall promptly notify the Government of any actual or potential issue that may affect schedule, quality, cost, sample integrity, data integrity, or contract performance.

7.4 Escalation of Issues

The Contractor shall notify the COR and Contracting Officer, as appropriate, within one (1) business day of becoming aware of any material issue involving:

- compromised samples,
- failed QC benchmarks,
- data loss,
- security incident,
- inability to meet required throughput,
- significant schedule slippage, or
- any event likely to impair performance.

8. KEY PERSONNEL

8.1 Project Manager

The Contractor shall provide a dedicated Project Manager as key personnel. The Project Manager shall serve as the primary point of contact and shall be responsible for overall coordination and management of contract performance.

8.2 Replacement of Key Personnel

The Contractor shall notify the Contracting Officer and COR in writing prior to replacing key personnel. Any proposed replacement shall possess qualifications at least equivalent to those of the individual being replaced, unless otherwise approved by the Government.

8.3 Continuity of Operations

The Contractor shall ensure continuity of operations sufficient to avoid disruption in performance due to personnel turnover, absence, or reassignment.

9. PLACE OF PERFORMANCE AND TRAVEL

9.1 Place of Performance

The principal place of performance shall be the Contractor's facility or facilities, unless otherwise approved in writing by the Government.

9.2 Travel

No travel is anticipated under this requirement. Travel shall not be reimbursable unless specifically authorized in advance and in writing by the Contracting Officer.

10. INSPECTION AND ACCEPTANCE

10.1 General

Inspection and acceptance shall be performed by the Government in accordance with the terms of the contract. The Government reserves the right to inspect all services and deliverables to determine compliance with contract requirements.

10.2 Acceptance Criteria

Deliverables shall be considered acceptable only if they:

1. are timely;
2. are complete;
3. conform to the technical and formatting requirements of the contract;
4. satisfy applicable quality control benchmarks; and
5. are free from material error, omission, or defect.

10.3 Government Remedies

If services or deliverables are deficient, nonconforming, incomplete, or untimely, the Government may, in addition to any other rights and remedies available under the contract or at law:

- require correction or reperformance at no additional cost;
- reject the deliverable in whole or in part;
- reduce payment, if authorized by the contract;
- require a corrective action plan; or
- pursue other contractual remedies.

10.4 Acceptance Not Waiver

Government inspection, review, or acceptance shall not waive any rights of the Government, including the right to require correction of latent defects, fraud, gross mistakes amounting to fraud, or noncompliance with contract requirements.

11. CONFIDENTIALITY, DATA PROTECTION, AND SECURITY

11.1 General

The Contractor shall protect all Government-furnished information, biospecimens, data, and materials against unauthorized access, use, disclosure, modification, loss, or destruction.

11.2 Restrictions on Use

The Contractor shall use Government-furnished biospecimens, data, and information solely for the purpose of performing this contract and for no other purpose unless expressly authorized in writing by the Contracting Officer.

11.3 Safeguards

The Contractor shall implement and maintain appropriate administrative, technical, and physical safeguards, including:

- access controls limiting access to authorized personnel;
- secure storage of physical and electronic materials;
- secure transmission methods;
- password protection or equivalent controls for electronic files; and

- procedures for incident reporting and response.

11.4 Privacy and Human Subjects Data

To the extent the Contractor receives or accesses personally identifiable information (PII), protected health information (PHI), coded human subject data, or other sensitive information, the Contractor shall comply with all applicable federal laws, regulations, HHS/NIH policies, and contract clauses governing privacy, confidentiality, and information security.

11.5 Security Incidents

The Contractor shall immediately, and no later than the timeframe required by the contract, report any actual or suspected security incident, unauthorized disclosure, loss of data, or compromise of Government-furnished materials to the Government in accordance with contract requirements.

11.6 Return or Destruction

Upon completion, expiration, or termination of the contract, the Contractor shall return or destroy Government-furnished data and materials, including copies, as directed by the Government and in accordance with the contract and applicable law.

12. QUALITY ASSURANCE AND PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

12.1 Quality Assurance

The Contractor shall maintain a documented quality assurance system sufficient to ensure that all services and deliverables conform to contract requirements.

12.2 Minimum Performance Standards

The Contractor shall:

- process samples in accordance with required methods and timelines;
- maintain throughput capacity up to 2,400 samples per week;
- apply required normalization and bridging controls;
- perform and document QC procedures;
- provide accurate and complete data files and reports; and
- promptly communicate issues affecting performance.

12.3 Corrective Action

Upon identification of any performance deficiency, the Contractor shall promptly investigate the cause, implement corrective action, and provide the Government with a written corrective action plan upon request.

13. CHANGES, STOP WORK, AND ORDER OF PRECEDENCE

13.1 Changes

Only the Contracting Officer may authorize changes to the scope, schedule, deliverables, quantities, or other terms of the contract. The Contractor shall not act upon any oral or written direction from any person other than the Contracting Officer that would constitute a change to the contract.

13.2 Stop Work

The Contractor shall comply with any stop-work order issued by the Contracting Officer in accordance with the applicable contract clause.

13.3 Order of Precedence

In the event of any inconsistency between this SOW and other contract documents, the order of precedence shall be governed by the applicable contract clause. Nothing in this SOW shall be construed to supersede mandatory FAR, HHSAR, or agency clauses incorporated into the contract.

14. ATTACHMENTS

The following attachments are incorporated into this SOW, as applicable:

- Attachment 1 – Sample Cohort Summary
 - Attachment 2 – Deliverable Schedule
 - Attachment 3 – Data File Format Requirements
 - Attachment 4 – Shipping and Chain-of-Custody Procedures
 - Attachment 5 – Security and Confidentiality Requirements
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ATTACHMENT 1 – SAMPLE COHORT SUMMARY

Contract Period Cohort		Maximum Number of Samples
Base Year	PREVENT-AD	3,738
Base Year	Geneva	2,131
Base Year	DABNI/SPUN	3,101
Option Year 1	DABNI/SPUN	1,406
Option Year 1	K-ROAD	7,564
Option Year 2	K-ROAD	1,236
Option Year 2	Unspecified Neurodegenerative Disease Cohort	7,734
Maximum samples per contract year: 8,970		

ATTACHMENT 2 – DELIVERABLE SCHEDULE

Deliverable	Format	Due Date
Raw sequencing data	FASTQ via secure cloud server	Within 2 weeks of receipt of prepared libraries
Biomarker readouts	CSV	Within 2 weeks of sample processing
Data QC results	CSV	Within 2 weeks of sample processing
QC summary report	PDF	Within 2 weeks of sample processing
Bridging sample results	CSV and PDF	Within additional 2 weeks, provided QC benchmarks are met
Final QC-reviewed results	CSV/PDF as applicable	Within additional 2 weeks, provided QC benchmarks are met

ATTACHMENT 3 – DATA FILE FORMAT REQUIREMENTS

The Contractor shall provide data files in the following formats:

1. Biomarker Readouts: CSV files containing log2 values for each biomarker.
2. Quality Control Data: CSV files containing plate-level, batch-level, and study-level QC metrics.
3. Project Reports: PDF files summarizing QC findings and analytical observations.
4. Raw Data: FASTQ format delivered through a secure cloud server.

All file names shall follow a Government-approved naming convention, if provided.

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ATTACHMENT 4 – SHIPPING AND CHAIN-OF-CUSTODY PROCEDURES

The Government and Contractor shall coordinate biospecimen shipment procedures prior to performance. At a minimum, procedures shall address:

1. sample packaging and labeling;
2. temperature and preservation requirements;
3. shipment tracking;
4. receipt confirmation;
5. discrepancy reporting; and
6. chain-of-custody documentation.

The Contractor shall notify the Government promptly upon receipt of samples and identify any damaged, missing, or compromised materials.

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ATTACHMENT 5 – SECURITY AND CONFIDENTIALITY REQUIREMENTS

The Contractor shall maintain appropriate safeguards to protect Government-provided samples and data. Such safeguards shall include, at a minimum:

1. restricted access to authorized personnel;
2. secure storage of electronic and physical materials;
3. password protection or equivalent access controls for transmitted files;
4. secure transmission methods for all deliverables; and
5. compliance with all applicable federal laws, regulations, NIH policies, and contract clauses related to confidentiality, privacy, and data security.

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